COLLEGE OF CHARLESTON
D E P A R T M E N T OF FRENCH AND
FRANCOPHONE STUDIES



Cultural Panorama of the Francophone World:

Expressions of Francophone Identity and Culture

Fall 26- M/W 2:00 -3:15 pm, Maybank, 207

For administrative purposes this course syllabus is in English, but the course will be conducted in French.

Prerequisites: FREN 313 and FREN 314, and two of the following courses from the following sequence, FREN 334, FREN 335, FREN 336, FREN 337, FREN 362, FREN 362 or permission of the chair.

Instructor: Dr. Azza Benyoussef **Email**: benyoussefay@cofc.edu
Office Hours: M/W 1- 1: 45 pm, J.C Long, 412 & by appointment on Zoom.



Course Description:

This course offers an introduction to the diversity of the French-speaking world through the exploration of literary, historical, and cultural productions from various Francophone contexts. Through the study of texts, films, documentaries, music, and other forms of cultural expression from the Caribbean, Sub-Saharan Africa, the Maghreb, Québec, and other French-speaking regions, students will examine how language, identity, memory, migration, and social change shape Francophone societies.

The course explores major cultural questions related to belonging, representation, cultural exchange, gender, and the ways individuals and communities define themselves within changing social and historical contexts. Rather than approaching the Francophone world as a collection of separate regions, the course emphasizes connections and conversations across diverse linguistic and cultural spaces.

By engaging with a variety of Francophone perspectives and cultural productions, students will develop a broader understanding of the complexity and richness of French-speaking cultures around the world. Course materials, discussions, and assignments will be conducted in French and will encourage students to think critically, make connections across cultures, and engage with contemporary issues through multiple forms of cultural expression.

Course Objectives:

By the end of this course, students will be able to:

- Develop an understanding of the diversity of Francophone cultures and the historical, social, and cultural contexts that shape them.
- Identify and explore major themes related to language, identity, migration, memory, representation, and cultural exchange in the French-speaking world.
- Analyze literary, visual, and cultural productions within their cultural and historical contexts.
- Compare perspectives and experiences across different Francophone communities.
- Develop critical reading, viewing, and discussion skills through engagement with a variety of authentic Francophone materials.
- Participate effectively in conversations and discussions while engaging respectfully with diverse cultural perspectives.
- Strengthen French language proficiency through reading, writing, discussion, and analysis of Francophone cultural materials.

Films to watch outside of class before the scheduled discussion day:

- **Semaine 2 :** *Ma vie de Courgette* (2016) — **Claude Barras — Suisse** https://www.kanopy.com/en/coc/video/15309748
- **Semaine 3 :** *Indigènes* (*Days of Glory*) (2006) — **Rachid Bouchareb — Algérie / France** filmc
- **Semaine 6 :** Aimé Césaire, une voix pour l'histoire 1 (1995) — **Euzhan Palcy — Martinique** film
- **Semaine 9 :** *La Grande Séduction* (2003) — **Jean-François Pouliot — Québec (Canada)** https://www.kanopy.com/en/coc/watch/video/13001119
- **Semaine 12 :** *La Graine et le Mulet* (*The Secret of the Grain*) (2007) — **Abdellatif Kechiche — France / Maghreb** https://www.kanopy.com/en/coc/video/12157378

Readings and Course Materials

All assigned readings and articles will be available on **OAKS under Content**, organized by week. Students should go to the specific week to access the assigned materials.
When possible, readings will be provided as **PDFs** for easy access. Students are expected to complete all assigned readings **before the class for which they are assigned** and come prepared to discuss them.

Assignments and Evaluation

✓ Participation et engagement	15%
✓ Présentations culturelles francophones	15%
✓ Carnet culturel francophone	20%
✓ Carte culturelle francophone	10%
✓ Essais culturels (2)	20%
✓ Projet final : Podcast culturel francophone	20%

➢ **Participation et engagement en classe (15%)**

Active participation is an essential part of this course. Students are expected to come prepared, participate in class discussions and activities, and engage thoughtfully with the cultural materials and perspectives explored throughout the semester.

- **Présentations culturelles francophones (15%)**

Throughout the semester, students will give a short **individual presentation** connected to the theme, reading, film, or other cultural material assigned for that class session. Students will begin by identifying an aspect of the assigned material that they would like to explore further and then introduce a related cultural topic, example, figure, artistic production, current event, social issues, cultural practice, or other relevant perspective. The purpose of these presentations is to **deepen and expand our exploration of the Francophone world** by bringing additional information and perspectives to the class. Presentations should establish a clear connection to the assigned material, provide relevant context and specific examples, and conclude with a question or prompt to encourage class discussion. Presentations should be approximately **10 minutes**, followed by a brief discussion with the class. Each student will sign up for a presentation date using a **Google Doc provided by the instructor**. Students are responsible for selecting an available date and being prepared to present on the date they choose. Additional instructions and evaluation criteria will be provided during the semester.

- **Carnet culturel francophone (20%)**

Students will complete **five** short reflections throughout the semester on films, readings, documentaries, music, articles, or other Francophone cultural materials studied in the course. Each entry should move beyond summary by identifying important themes, making connections to course discussions, and reflecting on the student's evolving understanding of the Francophone world. The lowest grade will be dropped.

- **Carte culturelle francophone (10%)**

Students will create an individual **digital cultural map** exploring a Francophone place, community, cultural practice, artist, or cultural phenomenon of their choice. The project should introduce an aspect of the Francophone world that expands your knowledge beyond the specific materials studied in class.

Your Carte culturelle should include:

- a **title** and the Francophone place or cultural context you have chosen;
- a brief introduction to the topic;
- **3–5 key pieces of information** that help explain the topic;
- relevant **images, maps, or other visual elements**;
- specific examples that illustrate the cultural topic;
- a brief **personal reflection** explaining what you discovered and what you found interesting or significant; and
- a list of the **sources** you consulted.

The project should be **one page** and visually organized and engaging. It should be written primarily in **French**.

Format and Submission: You may create your Carte culturelle using Canva, PowerPoint, Google Slides, or another visual format. Save your final project as a **PDF** and submit it through the **Assignments section of OAKS**.

- **Essais culturels (20%)**

Students will complete **two** written essays in French during the semester. These essays will develop students' ability to interpret Francophone cultural productions, formulate an argument, and connect specific examples to broader themes explored in the course.

Each essay will be approximately 3–4 pages in length and will focus on the analysis of cultural materials studied in class, such as films, texts, music, documentaries, or other cultural productions. Students will be expected to move beyond summary by developing their ideas and supporting their analysis with specific examples.

Additional instructions, including essay prompts and evaluation criteria, will be provided during the

semester.

- **Projet final : Podcast culturel francophone (20%)**

For the final project, students will work **with a partner** to create a **12–15 minute video podcast in French** exploring **two connected cultural topics** related to the Francophone world. The topics may focus on cultural productions, communities, social issues, artists, cultural practices, or themes connected to the course. The two topics should have a **meaningful connection** and allow students to explore a broader cultural question or theme. Students should explain the connection between their topics rather than discussing them as two separate subjects. Unlike a formal presentation, the podcast should take the form of a **conversation between partners**. Students should ask and answer questions, exchange ideas, respond to one another's perspectives, and demonstrate their ability to discuss and interpret Francophone cultural materials. **Both students should participate actively and contribute substantially to the conversation.** The podcast should provide relevant context, incorporate specific examples, and connect the discussion to themes explored throughout the semester. The goal is not simply to present information, but to **engage in a thoughtful cultural conversation**.

- **Format and Submission:** The final project should be a **12–15-minute video recording** in French. The video should show both partners participating in the conversation. Students will submit the final recording through the **Assignments section of OAKS**.

Due date: December 8, 2026, at 3:00 p.m. Additional instructions and evaluation criteria will be provided during the semester.

The departmental grading scale:

A	93-100	**C**	73-77
A-	90-92	**C-**	70-72
B+	88-89	**D+**	68-69
B	83-87	**D**	67
B-	80-82	**D-**	66
C+	78-79	**F**	0-65

Attendance, Participation, and Personal Electronic Devices

Regular attendance and preparation are essential to your success in this course. You are expected to attend every class meeting, complete the assigned readings before class, and participate actively in class discussions and activities.

Simply attending class does not constitute participation. A student who attends regularly but rarely contributes to discussions or activities can expect no more than a C for participation.

You may have two free absences during the semester. Beyond these two absences, additional absences will negatively affect your participation grade. An absence may be excused when properly documented through

the Dean's Office. If you anticipate an absence, please communicate with me as soon as possible.
Personal Electronic Devices: This course is a device-free classroom. Please put away all personal electronic devices—including cell phones, tablets, laptops, and smartwatches—before entering the classroom and keep them put away until class ends. The use of electronic devices is permitted only when explicitly authorized by the instructor, such as when a device is needed to access assigned readings or course materials.

Email and Office Hours

Email: Please allow **24 hours for a response to emails** during the week. I do not respond to emails from **Friday at 5:00 p.m. through Monday morning**. When emailing me, please use your College of Charleston email account and include the course number in the subject line.
Office Hours: Office hours are available by appointment. Please email me to schedule a meeting, either in person or via Zoom. I am happy to meet with you to discuss course material, assignments, your progress in the course, or any questions you may have.

Course Communication and Updates

The syllabus provides the general framework for the course but is **subject to updates and changes** as the semester progresses. Any changes to the course schedule, assignments, deadlines, or specific instructions will be communicated through **OAKS Announcements**.
Students are responsible for **checking OAKS regularly and reading all announcements carefully**. Important information, reminders, and instructions may be provided through announcements, and students are expected to stay informed about any updates to the course.

Late Work

Assignments must be submitted by the stated due date and time. You are responsible for keeping track of deadlines and submitting your work on time.
If you anticipate that you will need accommodation or an extension for an assignment, **you must contact me by email before the assignment's due date**. Requests made after the deadline may not be accommodated.
Please do not wait until the last minute to contact me if you know that circumstances may affect your ability to submit an assignment on time.

Holistic Assessment

Assignments in this course will be evaluated using a **holistic approach**. Rather than assigning separate points to individual criteria, I will consider the work as a whole and determine an overall grade based on several aspects of your performance. You will receive **one overall grade along with comments and feedback** highlighting the strengths of your work and areas for improvement.
In evaluating your work, I will consider:

- **Understanding of the topic:** Demonstrates a clear understanding of the cultural material, readings, films, and questions addressed in the course.
- **Critical thinking and development of ideas:** Goes beyond description or summary to develop an interpretation, make connections, ask meaningful questions, or offer a thoughtful perspective on the material. I am interested not only in **what** you observe, but also in **how and why** you interpret it.
- **Use specific examples:** Supports ideas with relevant and specific examples from the readings, films, class discussions, or other course materials. Examples should be explained and connected to your ideas rather than simply listed.
- **French language:** Uses clear and comprehensible French, with appropriate vocabulary, grammar, sentence structure, and attention to accuracy.
- **Personal engagement and voice:** Demonstrates your own perspective, observations, interpretation, and intellectual engagement. The work should reflect **your thinking and your**

voice.

- **Quality and effort:** Shows care in preparation, organization, proofreading, and revision.

Your Work Must Be Your Own

Your work must be personal and original. I want to hear **your voice, your ideas, and your interpretation** of the material. You are encouraged to express your own opinions and perspectives and, when appropriate, to use the first person (*je*).

You are **not expected to write perfect French**. Making mistakes is a natural part of learning a language and will not, by itself, prevent you from earning a strong grade. What matters is that you make a genuine effort to communicate your ideas clearly and accurately.

At the same time, your work should demonstrate **your own critical thinking**. Simply summarizing a reading, describing what happened in a film, or repeating ideas presented in class is not enough. Strong work takes the material as a starting point and develops an individual response to it.

The use of ChatGPT or other generative AI tools is not permitted for course assignments. Your submitted work must represent your own thinking, writing, and language abilities. The goal is not to produce a perfect text; the goal is to show **what you understand, what you think, and how you are developing your ability to express your ideas in French**. Using AI to produce your work does not meet the expectations of this course.

College of Charleston Honor Code and Academic Integrity:

As members of the College of Charleston community, we affirm, embrace, and hold ourselves accountable to the core values of integrity, academic excellence, liberal arts education, respect for the individual student, diversity, equity and inclusion, student centeredness, innovation and public mission. Congruent with these core values, the College of Charleston expects that every student and community member has a responsibility to uphold the standards of the honor code, as outlined in the Student Handbook, In pursuit of academic learning, you are expected to reference the work of other scholars, and complete your own academic work, while utilizing appropriate resources for assistance. Any acts of suspected academic dishonesty will be reported to the Office of the Dean of Students and addressed through the conduct process. Your adherence to these practices and expectations plays a vital role in fostering a campus culture that balances trust and the pursuit of knowledge while producing a strong foundation of academic excellence at the College of Charleston. Any questions regarding these expectations can be clarified by your instructor.

Generative Artificial Intelligence (GAI): Intellectual honesty is vital to an academic community, for your successful development as a second language learner, and for my fair evaluation of your work. All work submitted in this course must be your own. Unless otherwise specified, the use of Automated Writing Tools, including ChatGPT and similar generative artificial intelligence (GAI) tools, is strictly prohibited in this course, even when properly attributed. The use of automated writing tools will be considered plagiarism and a violation of Academic Integrity as outlined in the CofC Honor Code.

Accommodations for Students with Disability

The Center for Disability Services/SNAP is committed to assisting qualified students with disabilities achieve their academic goals by providing reasonable academic accommodations under appropriate circumstances. If you have a disability and anticipate the need for accommodation in order to participate in this class, please contact the Center for Disability Services/SNAP. They will assist you in getting the resources you may need to participate fully in this class. You can contact the Center for Disability Services/SNAP office at 843.953.1431 or at snap@cofc.edu. You can find additional information and request academic accommodation at the Center for Disability Services/SNAP website. Students approved for accommodation are responsible for notifying me as soon as possible and for contacting me one week before accommodation is needed.

Diversity and Inclusion in the classroom

I am committed to creating an inclusive and accessible classroom environment for all students. I view the diversity that students bring to this class as a resource, strength, and benefit. It is my intent to present materials and activities that are respectful of diversity: gender, sexuality, disability, generational status, socioeconomic status, ethnicity, race, religious background, and immigration status. Any suggestions for promoting a positive and open environment will be appreciated and given serious consideration.

I will gladly honor your request to address you by the name and gender pronouns of your choice. Please advise me of this early in the semester via your college-issued email account or during office hours so that I may make the appropriate notation on my class list.

Inclement Weather, Pandemic or Substantial Interruption of Instruction

If in-person classes are suspended, faculty will announce to their students a detailed plan for a change in modality to ensure the continuity of learning. All students must have access to a computer equipped with a web camera, microphone, and Internet access. Resources are available to provide students with these essential tools. If the College of Charleston closes and members of the community are evacuated due to inclement weather, students are responsible for taking course materials with them in order to continue with course assignments consistent with instructions provided by faculty. In cases of extended periods of institution-wide closure where students have relocated, instructors may articulate a plan that allows for supplemental academic engagement despite these circumstances.

Course Schedule and Materials

The course schedule below provides an overview of the themes, readings, viewings, and assignments planned for the semester. Please note that the syllabus is subject to change as needed to better support the goals of the course. Any modifications to the schedule, readings, assignments, or deadlines will be communicated **through Announcements on OAKS.**

All course materials, including readings, PDF documents, videos, and other resources, will be available on OAKS under the **Content** section. Students are responsible for checking the weekly modules regularly and completing the assigned materials before class.

Week / Theme	**Class**	**Before Class: Readings, Viewings**	**In class & Assignments**
Week 1 Qu'est-ce que la F/francophonie ?	08/17		Introduction
	08/19	Lire : JMG. Le Clezio, *Francophonie : la langue française comme « terre d'accueil »* (Oaks>Content> Week1)	Discussion
Week 2: Francophonies européennes	08/24	Regarder: https://www.youtube.com/shorts/nqpdZa_GDoU video	Discussion

	08/26	Regarder : ***Ma vie de Courgette* (2016)** — Claude Barras – Suisse https://www.kanopy.com/en/coc/video/15309748	Discussion
Week 3 : L'Algérie, histoire et mémoire	08/31	Lire: Assia Djebar , *Ces Voix qui m'assiègent* (Extraits)	Discussion
	09/ 02	Regarder: *Indigènes* (*Days of Glory*) (2006) Rachid Bouchareb — Algérie / France	Carnet Culturel 1 Paper submission in class
Week 4 : Tunisie et Maroc	09/07	Lire : Albert Memmi, *La Statue de sel* (1953) — extrait Lire : Cecile Othmani, Tunie, Carnets d'incertitude (2013)	Discussion
	09/09	Tahar Ben Jelloun, *La Prière de l'absent* (1981) — selected excerpt Leïla Slimani, *Le pays des autres* (2020) — Extrait	Discussion
Week 5 : L'Afrique de l'Ouest, entre hier et aujourd'hui	09/14	**Léopold Sédar Senghor — « Femme noire » + selected poems**	Discussion
	09/16	Ahmadou Kourouma — *Le Crépuscule des indépendances* — extrait	Carnet Culturel 2 Paper submission in class Discussion
Week 6 : Les Antilles françaises : créolité et expressions culturelles	09/21	Regarder : Aimé Césaire, une voix pour l'histoire 1 (1995) — Euzhan Palcy — Martinique **video** **À lire :** Aimé Césaire, *Cahier d'un retour au pays natal* — short excerpt	Discussion
	09/23	**Maryse Condé**, *Le Cœur à rire et à pleurer* — extraits : « Portrait de famille »	Carnet Culturel 3 Paper submission in class

			Discussion
Week 7 : La cuisine et la mode dans le monde francophone	09/28	À lire :Dany Laferrière, *L'Odeur du café* (1991) À regarder :*Invitation au voyage* — « En Côte d'Ivoire, le riz sauce graine de Guetou » (ARTE) https://www.arte.tv/fr/videos/120083-042-A/invitation-au-voyage/	
	09/30	À lire : • Musée national d'Histoire naturelle, « Qu'est-ce que le wax ? » — lecture courte (3 min) https://www.mnhn.fr/fr/qu-est-ce-que-le-wax À regarder **:** • *À Abidjan, décoloniser la mode africaine* (ARTE, 2026) — 3 min https://www.arte.tv/fr/videos/132486-000-A/a-abidjan-decoloniser-la-mode-africaine/	Discussion
Week 8 : Musique, sport et expressios artistiques	10/05	À regarder / écouter : • Stromae, « Alors on danse » — clip officiel video • Amadou & Mariam, « Beaux Dimanches » (« Dimanche à Bamako ») — Mali video À lire **:** UNESCO, « La rumba congolaise sur la Liste représentative du patrimoine culturel immatériel de l'humanité » https://www.unesco.org/fr/articles/la-rumba-congolaise-sur-la-liste-representative-du-patrimoine-culturel-immateriel-de-lhumanite	Essai 1 Paper submission in class Discussion
	10/07	À lire: • Musée national de l'histoire de l'immigration, « Football et immigration en France » https://www.histoire-immigration.fr/en/node/3228 À regarder:Extraits de la Coupe du monde	Discussion

		1998 — l'équipe de France « Black-Blanc-Beur » Extraits de la Coupe du monde 2026 — l'équipe de France	
Week 9 : Québec, une francophonie nord-américaine	10/12	**Fall break : No class**	
	10/14	À lire: • Félix-Antoine Aubin, « Le joual, ou quand la langue se délie », Bibliothèque et Archives nationales du Québec (BAnQ) https://www.banq.qc.ca/explorer/articles/le-joual-ou-quand-la-langue-se-delie/ À regarder **:** • *La Grande Séduction* (2003) — Jean-François Pouliot — Québec (Canada)	Discussion
Week 10 : Croyances, laïcité et diversité culturelle	10/19	Laïcité et universalisme français À lire : • Lumni, « La laïcité » https://www.lumni.fr/article/la-laicite À regarder: • Lumni, « Petite histoire de la laïcité » — 3 min 29 https://www.lumni.fr/video/petite-histoire-de-la-laicite	Carte culturelle sur Oaks Discussion
	10/21	Lire : Mondialisation, diversité culturelle et francophonie article	Discussion
Week 11 : Femmes et transformations sociales dans le monde francophone	10/26	À lire: • Fatou Sow, « L'enjeu majeur du féminisme africain » — extrait https://sn.boell.org/fr/2023/09/26/lenjeu-majeur-du-feminisme-africain-extraits-de-discours-de-fatou-sow À regarder: • ARTE, « Au Bénin, les religieux encouragent l'entreprenariat féminin » — 3 min https://www.arte.tv/fr/videos/132710-000-A/au-benin-les-religieux-encouragent-l-entreprenariat-feminin/	Carnet Culturel 4 Paper submission in class Discussion

	10/28	À lire: • Maïssa Bey, *Cette fille-là* (2001) — extrait —	Discussion
Week 12: Familles, communautés et transmission culturelle	11/02	Regarder : *La Graine et le Mulet* (*The Secret of the Grain*) (2007) — Abdellatif Kechiche **https://www.kanopy.com/en/coc/video/12157378**	Discussion
	11/04	À lire: Fatou Diome, *Le Ventre de l'Atlantique* (2003), chapitre 1	Discussion
Week 13 : Défis environnementaux dans le monde francophone	11/09	À regarder : • ARTE Reportage, « Sénégal : arbres de vie » — 13 min Reforestation, déforestation, mangroves, agriculture and community action. It is available until 2052, so this is a particularly safe choice. Voir la vidéo — ARTE	Essai 2 Paper submission in class
	11/11	À regarder : • ARTE, « La mangrove, terre nourricière des Martiniquais » — 14 min https://www.arte.tv/fr/videos/123245-000-A/la-mangrove-terre-nourriciere-des-martiniquais/	Discussion
Week 14: Tahiti :cultures autochtones et francophonie du Pacifique	11/16	Extraits de *L'Ile des rêves écrasés* de Chantal T. Spitz.	Carnet Culturel 5
	11/18	Extraits de L'Ile des rêves écrasés de Chantal	Discussion

		T. Spitz.	
Week 15 : Le français en mouvement : Franglais et nouvelles façons de parler	11/23	TV5MONDE Info — **« Camfranglais : mélange de français, d'anglais et de langues locales »** video	Discussion
	11/25	Thanksgiving Break : No class	
	11/30	**Last Day of Class**	

Projet final: Podcast culturel francophone on 12/08 by 3 :00 pm on Oaks.